REQUIREMENTS REVIEW · USER STORIES · RISK ASSESSMENT

PawHome: requirements review and user stories for a trust-first pet-care marketplace

I turned user-validation findings into eight testable user stories with acceptance criteria, found five gaps that would have caused disputes or legal exposure, and ranked the product risks before development.

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Portfolio sample · November 2026

> Case built on **PawHome**, a pet-care marketplace prototype created by a university team (Master in IT & Management, PUC Chile, 2025). The requirements review, test design, test execution and reports in this document are my own work. Screenshots come from the prototype; no real users or payments were involved.

Context

PawHome connects pet owners with vetted caregivers who host pets in their own homes. The team's research (survey N=80, prototype interviews N=7) showed that the problem is not lodging but **uncertainty**: owners fear the pet escaping, not eating, or an irresponsible caregiver. Users asked for proof, not promises: background checks, real photos of the home, emergency protocols and a visit before paying for a stay.

What I delivered

- Backlog structured in four epics in Jira, with eight user stories written in the "As a... I want... so that..." format.
- Acceptance criteria that can be tested, including edge cases (expired checks, no answer in 24 hours, overlapping dates).
- Five requirement gaps logged as tasks, each with the business risk and the questions the Product Owner needs to answer.
- A risk matrix to decide what to build and test first.

User stories and acceptance criteria

ID	Story	Key acceptance criteria
PAW-5	**Caregiver verification** As a pet owner, I want to see that a caregiver's identity and background check were verified, so that I can trust them before I share my pet's details.	• Verified caregivers show "ID verified" and "Background check" badges with the verification date. • Pending, rejected or older-than-12-months checks show no badge, and the caregiver cannot receive requests. • Tapping a badge explains what was checked and when.
PAW-6	**Caregiver verification** As a pet owner, I want real photos of the caregiver's home, including fences and window netting, so that I can judge if it is safe.	• At least five photos, covering entrance, sleeping area, outdoor area or fence, windows or balcony, and the pet's space. • Fence height is required for houses; window and balcony netting must be declared for apartments. • Photos older than 12 months show an "update photos" warning.
PAW-7	**Caregiver verification** As a pet owner, I want to know who lives in the caregiver's home, so that I can choose a calm environment for my pet.	• Profile shows children, other pets and smokers at home. • "No children" and "No other pets" filters return only matching caregivers. • Changes in household data notify owners with active bookings.

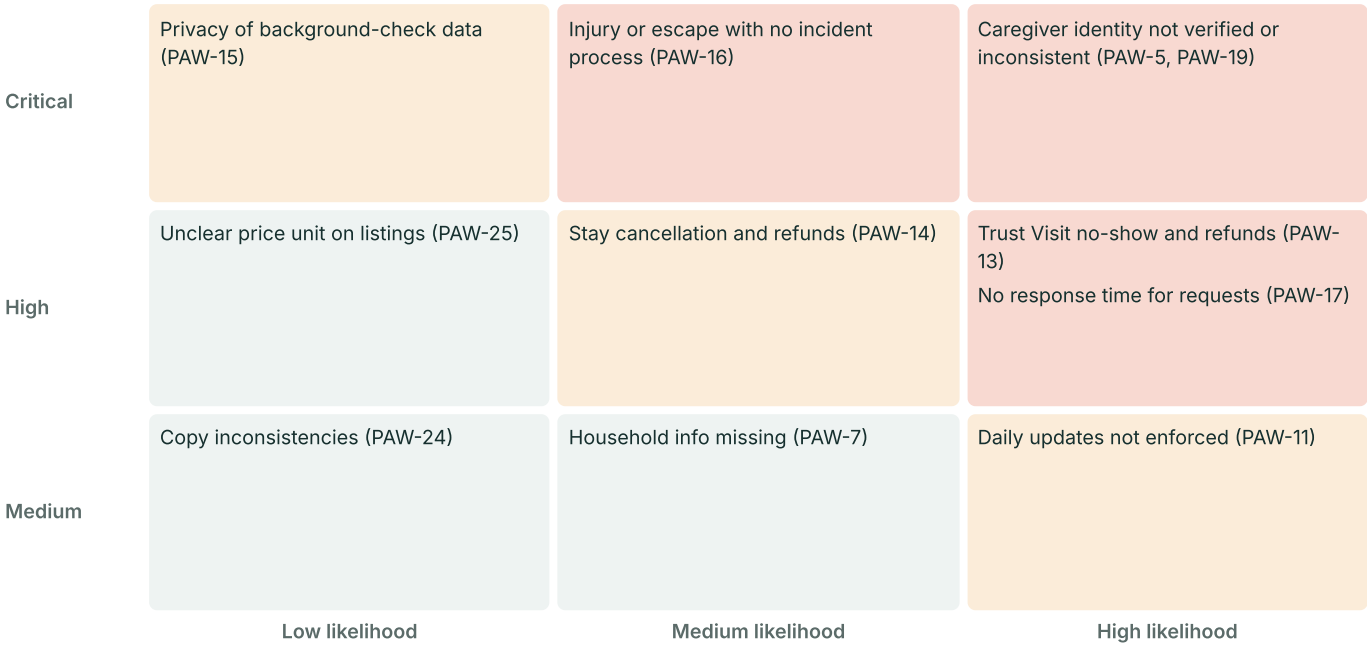
ID	Story	Key acceptance criteria
PAW-8	**Pet profile** As a pet owner, I want to record my pet's health, feeding and routines, so that the caregiver has a complete care manual.	• Species, size, feeding schedule, behaviour with other animals and own vet are required. • Each medication requires name, dose and time. • Medical details are visible to the caregiver only after the booking is accepted.
PAW-9	**Trust Visit & booking** As a pet owner, I want to book a paid Trust Visit before the first stay, so that I can meet the caregiver before committing.	• Owner chooses in person or video and proposes up to three time slots. • The CLP 2,000 fee is paid before the visit is confirmed. • No caregiver answer in 24 hours cancels the request and refunds the fee. • A stay can be booked only after both parties confirm the match.
PAW-10	**Trust Visit & booking** As a pet owner, I want to request a stay with clear dates and price, so that I know exactly what I will pay.	• Booking is blocked, with an explanation, until a Trust Visit is completed. • Dates that overlap the caregiver's calendar cannot be selected. • Nightly rate, nights, platform fee and total are shown before payment.
PAW-11	**Stay updates & emergencies** As a pet owner, I want a daily photo and note during the stay, so that I am not left wondering how my pet is.	• At least one photo and note per day. • No update by 21:00 sends a reminder and shows "update pending" to the owner. • Owner is notified within 5 minutes of each update.
PAW-12	**Stay updates & emergencies** As a pet owner, I want the caregiver to have a predefined emergency protocol, so that my pet gets help fast.	• A backup vet clinic is required before receiving bookings. • An approved first-aid certificate shows a "First aid" badge. • The "Emergency" button calls and notifies the owner and shows the backup vet.

Requirement gaps found

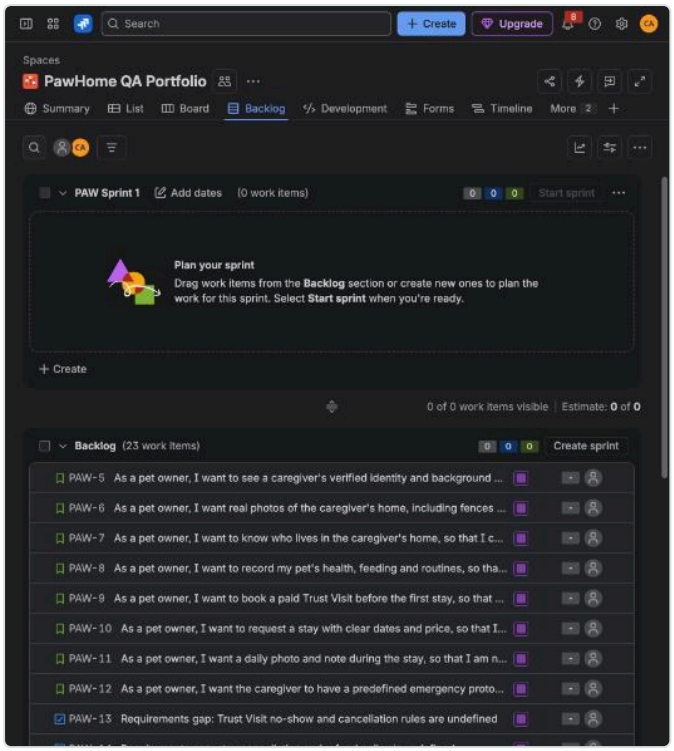
ID	Gap	Business risk	Questions for the Product Owner
PAW-13	**Trust Visit no-show and late cancellation rules are undefined**	Refund disputes in the very first paid interaction.	Is the fee refunded if the caregiver or the owner does not show up? How late can each side cancel?
PAW-14	**No cancellation or refund policy for stays**	Payment disputes, chargebacks and support load.	Refund percentage by days before the stay? Replacement caregiver if the caregiver cancels?
PAW-15	**No consent, access or retention rules for background-check data**	Privacy and legal exposure; caregivers may refuse to upload documents.	Store documents or only the result? Who can see them? How long are they kept? Which privacy rules apply?
PAW-16	**No process for injury, escape or vet costs during a stay**	Highest-impact scenario for the business has no defined handling.	Insurance or guarantee? Who pays emergency vet costs? How is an incident reported?
PAW-17	**No caregiver response time for stay requests**	Owners wait close to their trip, recreating the uncertainty the product promises to remove.	What is the response window, and what happens when it expires?

Product risk matrix

Impact on the business (rows) against likelihood (columns). Red cells are tested first and need a decision before development.



Backlog in Jira



Backlog: epics, stories, requirement gaps and bugs in one project.

How the backlog is organised

- Epics follow the trust journey: verification, pet profile, Trust Visit and booking, stay updates and emergencies.
- Requirement gaps are tasks linked to their epic, so they are resolved before the stories are built.
- Bugs from testing are linked to the same epics, which keeps requirements and quality in one view.

Carla Achury · Santiago, Chile (GMT-3) · English and Spanish · Portfolio sample, all content produced for this case.